

UNIT TITLE: PREPARE A BUSINESS LETTER IN ADVANCED ENGLISH		NOMINAL HOURS: 60
UNIT NUMBER: D1.LAN.CL10.10		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to write a business letter in advanced English in the workplace		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA	UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE	
Element 1: Recognise the purposes of different types of business letters in the workplace 1.1 Identify <i>the purposes of various business to business letters</i> 1.2 Identify <i>the purposes of business to customer letters</i> 1.3 Identify <i>the purposes of letters from employer to employee</i> Element 2: Understand the conventions of a writing a business letter in English 2.1 Identify <i>an appropriate format for a business letter</i> 2.2 Explain the importance of <i>tone</i> when writing a business letter in English 2.3 Discuss <i>the type of language preferred in business letters in English</i> 2.4 <i>Plan a response to a business letter</i>	Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment This unit applies to all industry sectors within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: 1. Front Office 2. Housekeeping 3. Food and Beverage Service 4. Food Production 5. Travel Agencies 6. Tour Operation <i>The purposes of various business to business letters may include:</i> • Explaining terms and conditions • Complaining about faulty goods or poor service, or to request a refund • Following up informal or formal discussions and to formalise decisions • Giving a price quotation • Giving credit approval, or refusal	

Element 3: Apply the conventions of writing a business letter in English 3.1 Apply an appropriate format for a business letter in English 3.2 Use an appropriate friendly and professional tone when writing a business letter in English 3.3 Use the type of language preferred in business letters, including correct spelling, punctuation and grammar	• Informing through product information, or sales letters • Introducing a person, or policy • Inviting through invitational letters to launches and other events • Persuading through promotional, or marketing and sales offer letters. <i>The purposes of business to customer letters may include:</i> • Confirming bookings, itineraries, payments • Sending an invitation • Offering special deals and discounts • Persuading • Providing information about terms and conditions • Responding to a complaint, suggestion or enquiry • Thanking and welcoming new customers. <i>The purposes of letters from employer to employee may include:</i> • Confirming employment and welcoming employee • Outlining company policies and procedures • Explaining employee's responsibilities and entitlements • Congratulating and acknowledging fine performance • Confirming staff appraisal outcomes and training plans • Warning and/or dismissing. <i>An appropriate format for a business letter may vary from enterprise to enterprise and relates to:</i> • Layout regarding the inclusion of a return address, date, inside address, salutation, e.g. Dear ...
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	• Paragraphs for the introduction, body of the letter and conclusion; usually aligned to the left margin • Closing, e.g. Yours faithfully when writing to someone for the first time; or yours sincerely • Signature, it is common practice for the full name to be signed if the person being written to is not known personally • Name and position is written below the signature; titles such as Ms. or Mr. Are not generally included • Abbreviations at the bottom of the page such as cc: and the person's name when a copy of the letter is sent to someone else • Business letters are usually word processed. <i>Tone</i> may relate to: • The friendliness conveyed e.g. When making a request, agreeing to a request, unable to meet a request, giving good and bad news • The degree of professionalism of the writer and general respect shown towards the reader • The relationship with the reader. <i>The type of language preferred</i> when writing a business letter in English should include: • Concise, unambiguous statements • Active voice rather than passive, e.g. <i>"I will see to it personally"</i> rather than <i>"The matter is being looked into"</i> • Language that has a reader friendly quality, e.g. words chosen are not obscure, or a big word is used where a smaller word would do; sentences are succinct and to the point and complex ideas are expressed simply • Language deals with specifics rather than vague generalities, e.g. <i>"Your order should arrive by next Monday"</i> rather than <i>"Your order should arrive soon"</i> • Non-sexist, non-discriminatory language
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	• Polite language rather than abrupt and bossy sounding language • Offers of help in the closing paragraph, e.g. <i>“Please do not hesitate to contact us again if you need any help”</i> or <i>“Please let us know if we can be of any assistance in the future”</i> • Cohesion achieved between and within sentences and paragraphs and the text as a whole by the use of connectives, discourse and time markers, reference and substitution • Correct spelling, punctuation and grammar. <i>Plan a response to a business letter</i> may relate to: • Knowing the purpose of the letter • Understanding who is going to read the letter • Deciding on the contents of each paragraph, i.e. The introduction, body and conclusion. Assessment Guide The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit: • Knowledge of the enterprise’s policies and procedures in regard to writing business letters in advanced English • Ability to identify the different types of business letters written in English in the workplace • Ability to analyse and apply an appropriate format for a business letter in English • Ability to plan a response to a business letter • Ability to use the correct tone in a business letter written in English • Ability to use the preferred language found in business letters • Ability to use correct spelling, punctuation and grammar. Linkages To Other Units • Build and maintain a team approach to service delivery • Establish and maintain a business relationship
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	• Organise functions • Maintain contacts with handling agents • Promote products and services to customers • Apply industry standards to team supervision • Implement, monitor and evaluate a training and development program • Plan and promote training courses • Manage and resolve conflict situations • Read and write English at an advanced level • Read and write English at a supervisory level. Critical Aspects of Assessment Evidence of the following is essential: • Understanding of the types of business letters written in advanced English likely to be encountered in the workplace • Demonstrated ability to plan a response to a business letter that has a clear purpose, is mindful of the audience and the contents of each paragraph • Demonstrated ability to use the correct format of a letter, including layout, inclusion of date, addresses, paragraphs, salutations and closings • Demonstrated ability to employ the correct tone in business letters which is friendly and professional • Demonstrated ability to write two business letters using preferred language, correct spelling, punctuation and grammar.
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	Context of Assessment This unit may be assessed on or off the job: • Assessment should include practical demonstration of writing a business letter in English either in the workplace or through a simulation activity, supported by a range of methods to assess underpinning knowledge • Assessment must relate to the individual's work area or area of responsibility. Resource Implications Training and assessment to include access to a real or simulated workplace with suitably qualified English as a Second Language (ESL) teachers; and access to workplace standards, procedures, policies, guidelines, tools and equipment. Assessment Methods The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit: • Worksheets • Observation of practical candidate performance • Oral and written questions • Case studies and simulations • Project and assignment work. Key Competencies in this Unit <i>Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively</i> <i>Level 2 = competence to manage tasks</i> <i>Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating</i>
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	Key Competencies	Level	Examples
	Collecting, organising and analysing information	2	Locate and gather facts and figures for a business letter
	Communicating ideas and information	2	Respond to a business letter
	Planning and organising activities	2	Plan a business letter
	Working with others and in teams	1	Discuss the purpose of various business letters with colleagues
	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	2	Identify trends in graphs, tables or charts
	Solving problems	2	Offer suggestions for suitable responses to different types of business letters
	Using technology	2	Use a word processor to prepare a business letter